

What you Need

It's not very expensive to set up your personal network anymore and the amount you will save by sharing your resources will more than cover the initial cost. Here's a list of items you need to purchase:

Network Interface Card

Make sure you buy 10/100 Mbps network cards for your PCs as the price difference between 100 Mbps and 10 Mbps cards is almost negligible. Each card should cost about Rs 400 to Rs 600. If you are using a cable Internet connection

then the machine connected to the Internet will need two network cards. This makes a total of three network cards. Dialup modem users would require just two network cards.

Cabling

You will need Category 5 UTP cables (commonly known as Cat 5 cables) to connect the computers. Specify for a 'crossover cable' in case you plan to connect only two computers. Good quality Cat 5 cables start at Rs 25 per metre. Remember to measure

the distance between your computers and to buy a little extra cable, as it's better to have some left over cable rather than finding that the length has fallen short.

Hub

If you plan to connect more than two computers, you'll need a hub. Hubs help in transferring data between computers over your network. You can find different types of hubs with port counts of 4, 8, 16, etc. Nowadays it's quite easy to buy a four-port 10 Mbps hub for Rs 750.

you are using a dialup modem. WinProxy will automatically detect your dialup connection. Choose 'No' if you are using a cable or DSL connection.

This will take you directly to the 'Configuring your network screen'. WinProxy will automatically detect your internal and external IP addresses (depending on how you connect to the Internet, viz. dialup or cable/DSL) and set up the proxy for you.



WinProxy automatically detects internal and external IPs

After WinProxy has verified your settings, you can access the Internet from any machine on your network, provided you have set up your network as described in the previous section.

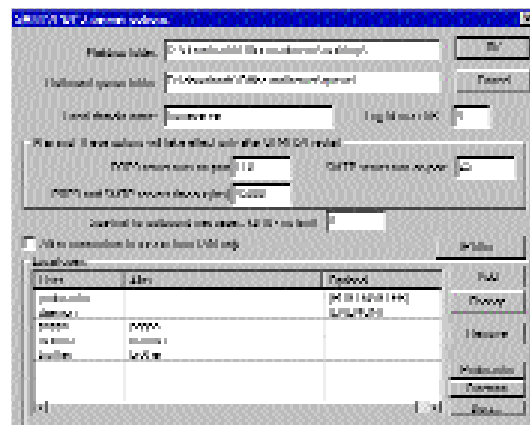
You've got mail

What if someone on the client PC (Home2) needs to send e-mail when the host PC (Home1) is not connected to the Internet? You might also want to send a Web link or some other information over the network. A mail server is an excellent solution for these problems. It will receive mail from all the PCs on the network and will relay them whenever the main server (Home1) is con-

nected to the Internet. Now you don't need to send local mail through the Internet and waste both your mailbox space and time. Instead, the mail server will automatically route them to the appropriate mailbox within the network.

Setting up the server

Office Mail Server is a simple, easy-to-configure, lightweight e-mail server. The server starts immediately without any cumbersome installation procedure. From the 'Options' menu select the 'SMTP/POP3' server options. Now we need to set up different user accounts and also configure the server to send and receive offline and online mail. The Maildrop folder holds all the mails that are downloaded from different accounts and the Outbound queue folder holds unsent messages. You can specify a different path if you want. The Local domain



Setting up user accounts in Office Mail Server

name will be the default domain name for all local mail. For example, if you enter 'homerserver' here, the local e-mail ID for all users will automatically become 'users@homerserver'. (See 'Setting your mail client' box for details on configuring your e-mail software to send and receive local mail).

Life's easier with ICS

If you're using Windows 98SE, 2000 or XP, there's no need to use a third-party software to share your Internet connection. These operating systems have in-built support in the form of Internet Connection Sharing (ICS).

ICS is not installed by default. It needs to be installed on the host computer i.e. Home1. To install ICS, go to *Control Panel > Add/Remove Programs*. Click on the 'Windows Setup' tab. Select 'Internet Tools' and click on the 'Details' button. Now select 'Internet Connection Sharing' and press 'OK'. Click on 'Apply' to finish the installation. Windows should

now ask for the Windows installation CD. The ICS wizard will automatically set up ICS for you. The only thing you need to remember is to make a 'Client Configuration Disk' when the wizard prompts you to. It saves time while setting up the client (Home2). Reboot Home1 after the installation is complete.

Now use the Client Configuration Disk to set up ICS on the client (Home2). Use the PING command to check if you can access Home1. At the command prompt type 'ping 192.168.0.2'. If you get a response, everything should be functioning okay.